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PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Friday, 28th November, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 1:28 p.m.*

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER, MR
BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

ABSENCE OF THE SPEAKER

Clerk to Parliament (Mr Ebenezer Ahumah Djietror): Hon Members, may I have your kind attention for this announcement. This is to inform you, of the unavoidable absence of the Rt Hon Speaker, in accordance with Standing Order 12(2). The First Deputy Speaker shall perform the duties and exercise the authority of Mr Speaker in relation to all proceedings of the House until the Rt Hon Speaker resumes the Chair.

I thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we would take the Correction of *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE
OFFICIAL REPORT**

The Speaker: Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 27th November, 2025, is under correction.

Page 1...9—

Yes, Hon Member?

Ing Surv Maxwell Kwame Lukutor: Mr Speaker, the page numbered 7, the second to last line of paragraph 5. It reads:

“The Order follows a petition by Mr Daniel Nsala Wakpal challenging the declaration of Hon Mathew Nyindam...”

The spelling of “Mathew” as stated in the quote above is different as compared to how it is regularly spelled on the page numbered 5, the item numbered 178. The name at the item numbered 178 is spelled as “Matthew”, and the one in the quoted text I read is spelled as “Mathew”. So, I would want to ask for the direction of the Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, please take note.

Page 8...12—

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, thank you so much.

On the item numbered 10, the Question numbered 220, the very first line—The Member’s Constituency is Ahafo Ano South West but in the *Votes and Proceedings*, it is spelled as “Aha Ano South West”.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, take note.

Page 13—

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am sorry, if I may. I was trying to catch your attention. On the page numbered 7, Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib did put in a leave of absence application. I followed up on it and it was approved. I just realised that he has been marked as absent. He was absent with permission.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I cannot recall approving Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib's leave of absence form.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: We ferried it to the Office of the Second Deputy Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, we should not be causing this confusion. All right. He is to work on the leave of absence.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, it is so.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Page 14...17—

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Afriye: Mr Speaker, I am very sorry. On the page numbered 13, under the item numbered 12, which is titled "MOTION", line 3, I propose that we insert the word "for" after the word

"Member" before the word "Nsawam/Adoagyiri".

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, take note.

Page 18...21.

Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 27th November, 2025 is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, indulge me to acknowledge the presence of students from Adamorobe Anglican Junior High School, led by Denis Opoku Addai, the head teacher. They are from Akuapem South and they are 54 in number.

[Pupils of Adamorobe Anglican Junior High School were acknowledged.]

We also have students from Pokrom Presby Junior High School, led by Miss Elizabeth Afriye, the Municipal Director of Education. They are from Akuapem South and they are 73 in number.

[Pupils of Pokrom Presby Junior High School were acknowledged.]

Then, we have CHRAJ Integrity Club, led by Araba Diaba, the Municipal Director of CHRAJ, Madina. They are from Madina and they are 51 in number.

[Members of CHRAJ Integrity Club were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: On behalf of Parliament, I welcome all of you. May you have a fruitful stay.

Hon Members, we are moving straight to the item numbered 6, the Business Statement. I will therefore call on the Chairman of the Business Committee, in the person of the Majority Leader and Leader of Government Business, to present the Business Statement for the ensuing week.

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

Chairperson of the Business Committee/Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, the Committee met yesterday, Thursday, 27th November, 2025, and arranged Business of the House for the Seventh

Week ending Thursday, 4th December, 2025.

Mr Speaker, the Committee accordingly submits its report as follows:

Arrangement of Business

Formal Communications by the Speaker

Mr Speaker, you may read any available communication to the House.

Question(s)

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee has scheduled the following Ministers to respond to Questions asked of them during the Week:

	<u>No. of Question(s)</u>
i. Minister for Food and Agriculture	6
ii. Minister of State in Charge of Public Sector Reforms	3
iii. Minister for Roads and Highways	10
iv. Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry	4
v. Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts	4

Total Number of Questions

27

Mr Speaker, in all, five Ministers are expected to attend upon the House to respond to Twenty-Seven (27) Questions during the Week. The Questions are of the following types:

- i. Urgent – 0; ii. Oral – 27

Statements

Mr Speaker, pursuant to Order 91(2), Ministers of State may be permitted to

make Statements on Government policies. You may also admit Statements

by Hon Members in accordance with Order 93.

Bills, Papers and Reports

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 159, Bills may be presented to the House for First Reading. However, those of

urgent nature may be taken through the various stages in a day in accordance with Order 160.

Pursuant to Order 97, Papers may be laid during the week and reports from Committees may also be presented to the House for consideration.

Motions and Resolutions

Mr Speaker, Motions may be debated and their consequential Resolutions, if any, taken during the week.

Committee Reports on Annual Budget Estimates and Related Motions

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee urges Chairpersons of Committees to expedite work on the consideration of the Annual Budget Estimates and report to the House to facilitate the passage of the Appropriation Bill, 2026 before the House adjourns *sine die*. Chairpersons are accordingly notified of the attached schedule for Committee reporting and the date for the Motions on the Annual Budget Estimates.

Mr Speaker, to engender transparency and public participation in the consideration of the Budget Estimates, the Business Committee proposes that Committees engage Civil Society Organisations and broadcast live proceedings of the consideration of the various Budget Estimates at Committee.

Mr Speaker, Chairpersons of Committees are entreated to schedule Committee sittings in the mornings

before noon. This is to ensure full participation of Hon Members when Business on the Floor commences.

Public Holiday

Mr Speaker, **Friday, 5th December, 2025** is Farmer's Day. The day would be observed as a statutory public holiday. Thus, the House will not sit. The Committee takes this opportunity to congratulate our dedicated and industrious farmers for their contribution to nation building.

Conclusion

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 216 (2) and subject to Order 67, the Committee submits to the House the order in which the Business of the House shall be taken during the week.

1:38 p.m.

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 216(2) and subject to Order 67, the Committee submits to the House the order in which the Business of the House shall be taken during the week.

Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

Tuesday, 2nd December, 2025

Roll Call

National Pledge

Statements

(a)Mr Kofi Arko Nokoe (Evaluate Ajomoro Gwira): To make a Statement on the State of

Housing in Ghana and the need for a National Affordable Housing Fund Act.

(b) Dr Mahama Tiah Abdul-Kabiru (Walewale): To make a Statement on the decline of youth Financing from the District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF) to the National Youth Authority (NYA) and the Youth Employment Agency (YEA).

(c) Mr Davis Ansah Opoku (Mpreaso) and Mr Abed-Nego Bandim (Bunkprugu): To make a joint Statement on strengthening key institutions to drive Ghana's Digital Transformation and Inclusion: Lessons from participating in the GIZ-Supported Tech Policy Fellowship.

(d) Mr Issah Atta (Sagnarigu): To make a Statement on opportunities for trade facilitation within and among African countries: challenges, weaknesses, and the way forward.

Questions

Q. 433. Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (Keta): To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what measures are being taken to control pests and diseases in crops and livestock.

Q. 428. Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (Keta): To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what initiatives have been implemented to boost agricultural production and increase farmers' income.

Q. 431. Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (Keta): To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture how the government is strengthening extension services to provide farmers with information on best practices.

Q. 465. Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong (Kwabre East): To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what the Ministry intends to do to address the volatility of the world market prices of cashew and its impacts on farm gate prices and exports.

Q. 528. Mr Lawrence Agyinsam (Hemang Lower Denkyira): To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture the plans to enhance the poultry value chain from production to processing and value addition, marketing and distribution and consumption and demand.

Q. 530. Mr Anthony Mmieh (Odotobri): To ask the Minister Food and Agriculture what interventions the Ministry is undertaking to ensure fair and equitable distribution of food nationwide in the light of the

increasing cost of foodstuff across the country especially in mining communities

Q. 236. Ms Gloria Owusu (Trobu): To ask the Minister of State in Charge of Public Sector Reforms what specific reforms the Ministry is implementing to improve efficiency, transparency and accountability.

Q. 249. Mr Samuel Awuku (Akwapim North): To ask the Minister of State in Charge of Public Sector Reforms what steps are being taken to digitise public services and reduce bureaucratic delays at key government agencies.

Q. 500. Mr Duke William Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta (Fanteakwa South): To ask the Minister of State in Charge of Public Sector Reform how the Public Records and Archives Administration Department (PRAAD) digitisation of 55,259 archival sheets and disposal of 8,540 boxes is improving records management, efficiency and what resources have been allocated for further digitisation in 2025.

Presentation of Papers

Motions

Presentation and First Reading of Bills

24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025

Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025
Governance Advisory Council Bill, 2025

Intestate Succession Bill, 2025
Committee Sitings

Wednesday, 3rd December, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

(a) Ms Dorcas Afo Toffey (Jomoro): To make a Statement on the Economic Empowerment and Financial Literacy of Women.

(b) Mr Charles Asiedu (Tano South): To make a Statement on the Urgent need to revitalise the Ghana Cylinder Manufacturing Company Limited.

(c) Mr Eric Edem Agbana (Ketu North): To make a Statement on the need to upgrade the Ohawu Agricultural College into a fully-fledged Agricultural University.

(d) Mr Sebastian Deh (Kpando): To make a Statement on supporting Smallholder Farmers in Ghana- The role of financial inclusion with tailor-made Innovative Financial Products.

Questions

Q. 377. Mr Yao Gomado (Akan): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when work will commence on the following areas in the Kadjebi District, since the Feeder Department completed the survey and mapping years ago: (i) Dodi-Papase to Dodo-Pepesu (ii) Dodo-Amanfrom to Daapa Junction (iii) Asato to Wawaso (iv) Koto-Nkwanta to Titiaka (v) Koto-Nkwanta to Sabram.

Q.453. Mr Yao Gomado (Akan) To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the following roads will be fixed: (i) Dodo – Olobi to Okrakrom (Koru) (ii) Akposokodzi Township Kadjebi road.

Q.455. Mr Sanja Nanja (Atebubu/Amantin): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways what immediate measures the Ministry is implementing to fix the potholes on the Amantin and the Yeji stretch of the Kumasi-Yeji Highway to prevent further deterioration of the road.

Q.380. Mr Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (South Tongu): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the government is going to renovate the Sogakope Bridge (Lower Volta Bridge),

especially the expansion gaps and the metal railings.

Q.381. Mr Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (South Tongu): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the current state of work on the Agave-Afedume road and when work will commence on site.

Q.476. Mr Kwabena Boateng (Ejisu): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the current state of the Ejisu-Onwe-Assieninpong-Kwaso road in the Ejisu Constituency and when work will resume to complete the road.

Q.512. Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction of the following abandoned roads will be resumed and completed (i) Maakro – Agogo- Twedie (ii) Supreme Saviour – Canaan.

Q.516. Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction of the following abandoned roads will be resumed and completed: (i) Bosankro Junction – Bosankro (ii) Akuapim Junction – Akuapim.

Q.517. Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction works will resume on the following roads: (i) Wiosu – Amanchia (ii) Nkawie – Nkran Foase (iii) Ntabanum Junction – Ntabanum.

Q.515. Mr Charles Forson (Tema Central): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the contractor for the Community 9 Light Industrial Area Road network will return to site.

Presentation of Papers

Motions

Committee Sitings

Thursday, 4th December, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

(a)Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (Old Tafo): To make a Statement on the need to prioritise the completion and optimal utilisation of existing Sports Infrastructure before initiating New Projects.

(b)Mr Richmond Edem Kofi Kpotosu (Ho Central): To make a Statement on the UHAS Leads Ghana in Global

Impact Rankings- A Beacon of Health, Innovation and Development.

(c)Mr Joseph Kwame Kumah (Kintampo North): To make a Statement on the urgent call to establish a Health Security Fund for Ghana.

(d)Mr Kwabena Boateng (Ejisu); to make a Statement on the deplorable condition of roads in the Ejisu Constituency.

Questions

Q. 286. Dr Isaac Yaw Opoku (Offinso South): To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the status of the Komenda Sugar Factory.

Q. 315. Mr Michael Okyere Baafi (New Juaben South): To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the status of the vehicle component manufacturing policy.

Q. 316 Prof Kingsley Nyarko (Kwadaso): To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the specific interventions the Ministry has taken to stimulate domestic production, increase export volumes and add value to our products to boost trade earnings.

Q. 401. Mr Lawrence Agyinsam (Hemang – Lower Denkyira): To ask the Minister for

Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the plans of the Ministry to increase exports to take advantage of the current cedi performance as well as increase the share of the trade sector to Ghana's GDP

Q. 367. Rev John Ntim Fordjour (Assin South): To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts the measures the Ministry is implementing to prevent the desecration of the Independence Arc, Kwame Nkrumah Mausoleum and other sacred national monuments by same-sex couples and LGBTQ+ activists.

Q.544. Mr Lawrence Agyinsam (Hemang Lower Denkyira): To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts the plans of the Ministry to expand employment to the indigenes in Kakum National Park enclave who have been marginalised from employment opportunities in the Constituency.

Q.577. Mr Charles Forson (Tema Central): To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts how the Ministry

plans to implement the Black Star experience in 2025 and what institutional partnerships and private sector collaborations are being established to ensure its success as a diaspora tourism brand.

Q.595. Mr Felix Akwetey Okle (Bortianor Ngleshie Amanfro): To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts the plans of the Ministry to develop the Solo Monkey Forest in Bortianor to expand the tourism industry for economic development and sustainable ecological management.

Motion

Committee Sitings

Friday, 5th December, 2025
Public Holiday (Farmer's Day)

Proposed Schedule for the Presentation of Committee Reports and Date of Motions on the Annual Budget Estimates for the 2025 Financial Year of Ministries, Departments, Agencies and other Constitutional Bodies

No.	MDA / CONSTITUTIONAL BODY	COMMITTEE	DATE OF PRESENTATION OF REPORT	DATE OF MOTION
1.	National Media Commission	Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies	Tuesday, 2 nd Dec, 2025	Wednesday, 3 rd Dec, 2025
2.	Parliament and Parliamentary Service of Ghana	Committee on Parliamentary Affairs	“	“
3.	Audit Service	Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies	“	“
4.	Electoral Commission	Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies	“	“
5.	Ministry of Roads and Highways	Committee on Roads and Transportation	“	“
6.	Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources	Committee on Works and Housing	“	“
7.	Ministry of Transport	Committee on Roads and Transportation	“	“
8.	Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs	i. Committee on Local Government and Rural Development, and ii. Committee on Chieftaincy, Culture and	“	“

No.	MDA / CONSTITUTIONAL BODY	COMMITTEE	DATE OF PRESENTATION OF REPORT	DATE OF MOTION
		Religious Affairs		
9.	Office of the Legal Aid Commission	Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs	Tuesday, 2 nd Dec, 2025	Thursday, 4 th Dec, 2025
10	Office of the Special Prosecutor	Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs	“	“
11	Ministry of Sports and Recreation	Committee on Youth and Sports	“	“
12	Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment	Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions	“	“
13	Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection	Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare	Tuesday, 2 nd Dec, 2025	Thursday, 4 th Dec, 2025
14	Ministry of Defence	Committee on Defence and Interior	“	“
15	Ministry of Youth and Development and Empowerment	Committee on Youth and Sports	Wednesday, 3 rd Dec, 2025	Tuesday, 9 th Dec, 2025
16	Right to Information Commission	Committee on Information and Communications	“	“
17	Ministry of Finance	Finance Committee	“	“
18	Office of the Government Machinery	Committee on Public Administration and State Interest	“	“

No.	MDA / CONSTITUTIONAL BODY	COMMITTEE	DATE OF PRESENTATION OF REPORT	DATE OF MOTION
19	Ministry of Foreign Affairs	Committee on Foreign Affairs and Regional Integration	“	“
20	Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry	Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism	“	“
21	Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice	Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies	“	“
22	Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources	Committee on Lands and Natural Resources	“	“
23	National Labour Commission	Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions	“	“
24	National Development Planning Commission	Committee on Economy and Development	“	“
25	Ministry of Fisheries and Aquaculture Development	Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs	“	“
26	Ministry of Energy and Green Transition	Committee on Energy	Thursday, 4 th Dec, 2025	Wednesday, 10 th Dec, 2025
27	Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations	Committee on Information and Communications	“	“
28	Office of the Head of Civil Service	Committee on Public Administration and State Interest	“	“

No.	MDA / CONSTITUTIONAL BODY	COMMITTEE	DATE OF PRESENTATION OF REPORT	DATE OF MOTION
29	Public Service Commission	Committee on Public Administration and State Interest	Thursday, 4 th Dec, 2025	Wednesday, 10 th Dec, 2025
30	Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts	Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism	“	“
31	Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology	Committee on Environment, Science and Technology	“	“
32	Ministry of Food and Agriculture	Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs	“	“
33	Ministry of Education	Committee on Education	Tuesday, 9 th Dec, 2025	Thursday, 11 th Dec, 2025
34	National Commission for Civic Education	Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies	“	“
35	Ministry of Health	Committee on Health	“	“
36	Office of the Attorney- General and Ministry of Justice	Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs	“	“
37	Judiciary and Judicial Service	Committee on Judiciary	“	“
38	Ministry of the Interior	i. Committee on Defence and Interior ii. Committee on Security and Intelligence	“	“
39	Other Government Obligations	Budget Committee	Wednesday, 10 th Dec, 2025	Friday, 12 th Dec, 2025

No.	MDA / CONSTITUTIONAL BODY	COMMITTEE	DATE OF PRESENTATION OF REPORT	DATE OF MOTION
40	General Government Services	Finance Committee	“	“
41	Financial Bills	Finance Committee	Thursday, 18 th Dec, 2025	Thursday, 18 th Dec, 2025
42	*Appropriation Bill	Budget Committee	Friday, 19 th Dec, 2025	Friday, 19 th Dec, 2025

*The Appropriation Bill is expected to be taken through the various stages in accordance with article 106(13) of the Constitution and Order 160(4) of the Standing Orders.

Other Business of the House, including the consideration and passage of Bills, will be considered alongside the consideration of the Annual Budget Estimates for the 2026 Financial year.
Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Chairman of the Business Committee.

Hon Members, the Business Statement has been duly presented. The floor is now open for comments.

Yes, Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib?

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, thank you. Let me take this opportunity to commend the Leader of Government Business and the Majority Leader, Hon Mahama Ayariga, for the work so far. Just to bring to his attention and to the attention of your good self, that since January 2025, we have recorded a lot of market fires and my understanding is that the respected Leader would also look

at—I do not know if we are going to programme the Minister for Local Government and Rural Development or any other person whom we deem fit that these situations or issues are within the person's remit. If I may just list some of them.

Mr Speaker, on 2nd January, 2025, we had the Kantamanto market fire which destroyed over 7,000 shops. We had one person die, more than 14 injured.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Hon Member, what is your request?

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, when I finish, I will make the request. I—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Business Statement time should not be used as a basis of debating or stating issues not related to the Business Statement as presented. There are tools available for you as a Member of Parliament. So, pick a copy of the Business Statement and tell me where exactly the issue you are commenting on

is stated because you are to comment on the Business Statement as presented.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, some of us are always willing to learn, except that for Business Statement, my understanding is that apart from what has been captured for the ensuing week, there are issues that are affecting the informal level.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, so if you want to make a suggestion, you can go ahead and make the suggestion, but it is not a period for you to make a statement, debate or bring any other issue. That is why I am asking you, what is your comment?

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, I intend to make a suggestion. Respectfully, I intend to make a suggestion. This is as a result of a certain observation, and I thought that this affects the local economy or the informal economy, and that since our respected Leader is the Leader of Government Business.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, apart from all the tools available for you within the rules, you are to comment on the Business Statement, and do you think this is an appropriate period to do what you are about to do?

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, I will take a cue. If you will just allow me 30 seconds, just for our understanding that these are markets, and they affect the local economy, so that in the ensuing week, instead of going through Question time and all of that, that would take a lot more time.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, you can bring Questions and Statements to be admitted but the floor is now open for comment on the Business Statement as presented.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, very well. It is your direction, and I would oblige respectfully.

I was just hoping you would give me 30 seconds.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Any further comment on that?

Yes, Hon Vincent Ekow Assafuah?

Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah: Mr Speaker, thank you. When I checked page 1 of the Business Statement, I realised that in the ensuing week, we have only 27 Questions to be responded to by Ministers who have been programmed for the week. Considering the number of Questions that are pending, and per my checks, I know that we have more than 200 Questions that are pending. So, it is an appeal that I want to make to the Majority Leader, especially considering the time that we may be rising. It is possible that we may not be able to deal with all those Questions before we rise. I personally have about four Questions that are pending. So, if it is possible, the Majority Leader may want to have a second look at the number of Questions that have been programmed for the week.

Mr Speaker, secondly, about four weeks ago, a matter was raised here on

the Floor with respect to something very important that affects the performance of Members of Parliament in terms of our work.

Mr Speaker, today, if one goes to the Job 600 building, on the 8th, 10th and 11th floor that I am on, most of the offices are not having their air conditioners working and it has been like this for about five months. Coming to Parliament, and I will not have an office to be able to work from, especially now that we are also considering the Committees' work. It is an appeal that I am making to the Majority Leader and to yourself that, respectfully, let us kindly take this matter into proper consideration so that we would be able to perform our duties as Members of Parliament to the benefit of the Ghanaians.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further comments?

Yes, Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong?

Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong: Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity.

Mr Speaker, a number of Statements have been outlined for this week and even for the previous week and if we check the *Order Paper* for today, there are many Statements lined up. In my view, I do not think we would be able to exhaust all these Statements. But when we check the Business Statement as well, I had a Statement on cashew. I have not seen these Statements listed for next

week. I would like to request that these Statements also be programmed, especially on cashew, because the cashew season is imminent and is starting next month and it is important that the House gets to know all the challenges facing this industry, so that together, we can fashion out some strategies.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Is your Statement an urgent one?

Mr Onyina-Acheampong: Mr Speaker, no.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, if it is not an urgent Statement, then it will be programmed accordingly.

Mr Onyina-Acheampong: Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, may I thank the Leader of the House. I think a matter that has been discussed for some time is seeing light of day, where we would now get stakeholders and relevant institutions to come to Parliament during the Budget Estimates consideration and for their input. We also have designated Committee rooms where there will be live broadcast of these engagements. I want to commend the Leader for ensuring that this has seen the light of day.

1:48 p.m.

Mr Speaker, let us reference Statements that have been captured by the Hon Leader in accordance with Order 91, the Speaker may admit Statements,

and Hon Ministers of State may come and make policy Statements, and also, dovetailing into what Mr Onyina-Acheampong had mentioned. Last week, I monitored the *Order Paper*; his Statement on cashew was advertised. I know there were other Statements, and there are even other Statements that have been admitted yet have not found space on the *Order Paper*. We can get clinical if those that were advertised, just to be fair, could be teased out and get them captured, even if it is not captured in the Business Statement, but then captured in the *Order Paper*, so that we go serially. If one's Statement has been captured, we can go according to the number. When those that have been advertised in the *Order Paper* are dispensed of, then we can consider the others that have been admitted by your good self, but are not being programmed. If we do that, that will help us, and Hon Members will also get a prior notification of when their Statements will be taken, especially now that we are going to wait for a report of estimate consideration, so that we can have enough time to consider the Statement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, but if the Statement appears on the *Order Paper* and however taken out, then that is unfortunate.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, with respect, you and I know sometimes we have to vary the order of Business because of exigencies of time and Businesses we have to prosecute. Sometimes it is inadvertent, and we are compelled to do what we have to do.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I agree with you.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I have also seen a number of Questions admitted, and also to corroborate what Mr Vincent said. There are 27 Questions; I am a bit old in this House, not too old, to know that with the 27 Questions—We are entering into a week where we are now waiting for reports of estimates that we are going to consider, so actually we have some time. So, I think we can add a few Questions to the 27 Questions. I know a few sectors that have been outstanding, and maybe Table Office can apprise the Hon Leader, and then we can consider the feasibility of adding one or two sectors to the ones that have been programmed already.

Mr Speaker, again on the Questions, realistically, we have an average of 15 days to get the Appropriation Bill passed and for us to rise. We have a number of Questions. For some of the Questions, they either time-bound or issue-bound. So, the Table Office, again, can help the Business Committee to tease out those that are Urgent in terms of being time-bound or issue-bound. Then we can look at how we can navigate and get them answered before time elapses and they are no longer relevant. That is my suggestion to the Hon Majority Leader for us to look at.

Mr Speaker, I scanned through the Business Statement, and I know sometimes when we are about to adjourn, that is when we fix the time for the following day's Sitting. During the ensuing week, the Committees will be

meeting to consider their Estimate. If it pleases the House, we should fix the time at 2 p.m., then the morning hours can be devoted for the Committees to consider the Estimate. More often than not, it is the delay as a result of the generation of the Report that causes us to stay and adjourn deep into the night. When the Reports are ready, we can take as many reports as possible, and then we can duly adjourn as we should.

Mr Speaker, I have seen attached to the Business Statement the proposed shadow for the presentation of the Committee Report. I have seen that here, and I know this is based on the availability of the Estimate. Can we add these: the District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF), the Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund), and the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA)? These are very important statutory payments that should be considered, and I am reliably informed that these institutions are ready. So, if it finds favour, we should programme them or prioritise these three formulae so that they will be brought to the House as soon as possible to be considered.

Mr Speaker, unofficially, I have been engaging the Table Office. The Committee cluster system may have its advantages, and for that we can argue it out, but experience has shown that during Budget time, they do not help us. They delay the Reports unnecessarily.

I related to my Colleague, the Hon Majority Leader, that we should relate to the office of the Clerk; they must do something about the Committee Cluster

system. The intention for it is good, it is well placed, but during Budget time, it delays the Reports unduly.

We have just about 15 days; we on this Side are minded to support the Majority to get the Budget passed. Let it not be said that we are obstructionists and that we are delaying; we are speaking out of experience. Towards the end of the last Parliament, the Cluster system did not help; it delayed us.

Mr Speaker, we want to help them pass their Appropriation Bill, and it happens that it delays the reports unduly. Practically, what happens is that one or two persons will be working on about 10 or 15 Reports; it is a fact. The Table Office agrees with me, of course, it comes with some advantages, but the disadvantages are more.

Mr Speaker, this is my favourite, as a patriotic citizen of this country, last week, I raised a red flag on *galamsey*, which has caused the destruction of our water bodies. The Hon Majority Leader, in his response, said, among other things, that the Hon Minister will be here as many times as possible. I defer to him, at the Business Committee, I reminded him again, and they again agreed that they would programme the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources this week. I have scanned through the Report, and there is nothing. Is it the case that the Hon Minister of Lands and Natural Resources is so busy that he cannot come to this House to make a good representation in terms of where we are in the fight against *galamsey*? *Galamsey* is the topic of today. One moment,

excavators appear, and in the next moment, they disappear like ghosts; this is worrying. All the water bodies we have in this country, the Densu, the Ankobra, and the others, have a bad turbidity level; I am worried.

Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways just came into the Chamber, and he is announcing his presence; that is fine. He has forgotten today is Friday.

Mr Speaker, I am pleading with the Hon Majority Leader to find space. So that next week, Wednesday or Thursday, the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources could come and do the needful. The fight against *galamsey* cannot go on the normal tangent because the needed feedback and the results we are looking for, we are not getting it.

Mr Speaker, if we go to the Accra to Kumasi Highway, the *galamseyers* are getting close to the roads. The Hon Minister for Roads and Highways should be worried. I just hope they understand what is at stake, so that for once, they will not come and just make an academic Statement—[*Interruption*]

Mr Speaker, I am about to conclude. If Mr Speaker wants me to sit down, I can sit. But I was actually concluding that the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources—we are the representatives of the people; we have an oversight role. He cannot just come and make sweeping statements and go; we must give him clear guidelines. For instance, he must come and speak to the turbidity level of River Ankobra and Densu.

1:58 p.m.

He must tell us what we are doing to reclaim the lands that have been destroyed. That template must come from us. Leadership or the House must tell the Minister that these are the things we want to come and speak to. Among other things, you can come and see all the things we find relevant, but these ones must not be left out. The least we can ask is the Minister coming to tell us where the fight is, where they have got to, and what the challenges are. There is something they call water guards. How are these water guards impacting on the fights? What is the incidental effect of the water guards on the fight against *galamsey*? Ghanaians are worried. The Hon Leader is signaling the Speaker that it is time. Well, if he wants me to sit down, I can sit down. It is not a problem. But, Ghanaians are watching him. The Minister must be programmed to come in the ensuing week, because he has already told this House, and the Majority Leader is on record to have said that the Minister m

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You may conclude.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I will conclude, Mr Speaker. I was at the Business Committee meeting. The Hon Leader himself is here and he will bear witness. In fact, the Hon Leader was in a hurry, so he said that if I have something to say, I should say it because he has other meetings to attend. Then I reminded the Hon Leader that he assured us that the Minister for Lands and

Natural Resources will be here as many times as possible. He then instructed the Table Office that they should check and make sure they programme him. So, I was expecting that the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources would be programmed. I am surprised that he is not on the programme.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for enduring me.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, any further comments?

Yes, so let us take the last comment so that the Hon Majority Leader can come and respond and then we adopt the Business Statement.

Minority Leader, you have the floor.

Minority Leader (Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin): Mr Speaker, save that I asked him, and he said he would want to comment before he takes me.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, add yours to it.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Very well, thank you.

Mr Speaker, first, there is this issue of Mpox cases. It is on the rise. According to the Ghana Health Service (GHS), as of 25th November, 2025, there are confirmed cases of Mpox.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, under what Order are you doing that?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, is that where this Parliament is heading to? [**Some Hon Members:** Eii!] No, because, Mr Speaker, respectfully—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We are commenting on the Business Statement. There is an appropriate period.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: I have been a Majority Leader before. I need to lay a foundation, please. Let us not do it then they will say contempt. Please, give me some space. I am laying a foundation.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: A foundation for what?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: For the fact that, Mr Speaker, if the Business Statement is brought, it is for Members to comment on the Statement. In commenting on the Business Statement, they make input. They draw attention to matters that are in the country so that the Leader of Government Business, if he finds it fit, will now programme a Minister to address the matter or the Speaker will direct that this matter be considered. Mr Speaker, that is what I know. So, what is wrong with me bringing a matter up and requesting the Majority Leader that a Minister be programmed to address the House on it? So, listen to me first. I have been there before. I know the rules.

Mr Speaker, the Ghana Health Service reports of a rise in case of Mpox. They give official figure as 880. They also talk about the infections spreading and urge the public to be very vigilant. On this call, since the Ghana Health Service is advising members of the public to be vigilant and strictly observe preventive measures including personal hygiene and early reporting of symptoms, I propose that this is not a matter that the public can easily appreciate without the people's representatives being part of it as equal stakeholders. On that score, can the Hon Majority Leader programme the Minister for Health to come and brief the House and assist Members of Parliament with the necessary protocols so that MPs can relate to this when they get to their constituencies? Mr Speaker, Mpox infection rates rising is a serious matter and this is coming from the Ghana Health Service themselves in their database. They need us as stakeholders to help to deal with this matter. That is my first call to the Hon Majority Leader.

Mr Speaker, the second call is for the Minister for Food and Agriculture. This is what the European Union (EU) says. The EU is warning both Ghana and Cote d'Ivoire that there is a need for these two countries to ensure urgent reforms in their cocoa sector or risk losing significant global market share. The warning stems from increasing global demand for sustainable, environmentally responsible and traceable cocoa production. Key concerns include deforestation, poor farming practices and

weak compliance to sustainability standards. I would want to again make a call on the Majority Leader to programme the Minister for Food and Agriculture. In the Budget Statement and Economic Policy, cocoa is a key area that drives the economy in terms of the revenue received from the cocoa sector. It is important that the Minister comes to the House to brief the nation on steps that COCOBOD is taking to do reform in terms of its work so that we are able to let the international community also know that Ghana is just not sleeping on its request for reforms. Indeed, steps are being taken to ensure we engage in sustainable agriculture in our cocoa production.

Mr Speaker, the third issue has to do with the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA). Mr Speaker, last week, there were media reports to the effect that there are growing concerns regarding service providers who have claims outstanding. The NHIA itself reports that we have almost about 20 million Ghanaians who have signed on to the National Health Insurance Scheme (NHIS). If service providers are complaining of non-payments, what it means is that many of the people in the rural areas who otherwise would rely on health insurance will be driven away, especially in the private facilities. I would want to respectfully request the Hon Leader of Government Business to programme the Minister for Health to brief the House on steps that the Ministry is taking in collaboration with the NHIA

to ensure that claims are paid on time and service providers whose claims are long overdue are settled. While on it, it is also instructive to add that Zipline Ghana just this week announced the shutdown of three office centres. We know the critical role Zipline has been playing, especially in delivering medication for rural healthcare. They have announced that they have shut down because of over 170 million outstanding claims.

2:08 p.m.

Mr Speaker, it is important that the Minister for Health is able to address this House regarding steps being taken to deal with it. This is because it is not those of us in the cities that will suffer from this shutdown; it is those in the rural areas who would need emergency medical care. The need for them to get blood transfusions as quickly as possible is one of the reasons for bringing in Zipline.

Mr Speaker, my last point is that the Hon Minister for Finance and (Ag) Minister for Defence, came to brief us on the matter of the El-Wak Sports Stadium disaster, where eight young Ghanaian ladies lost their lives as a result of the stampede that took place when they were there for this recruitment exercise by the Ghana Armed Forces. The Minister promised a follow-up. May I know from the Leader of Government Business, if the Ag Minister for Defence can be programmed to share with us the steps being taken by Government in assisting the families in the funeral of these Ghanaian ladies who lost their lives, and

whether Government has in place any compensation package for their surviving dependents.

This is because the reports were that there were some difficulties and that arrangements were not sufficient to enable a smooth exercise to be undertaken. They had dependents and relatives, and it is important that as a nation that honours not only its heroes, but citizens who face such calamity, the families cannot just be told that, “accept our condolences”, and then the matter dies and nobody hears about it.

Mr Speaker, that said, I come to our *Order Paper* for today, page 11, the Motion numbered 29. Since June, this Motion that I moved regarding the many Ghanaian youth who were dismissed from their workplaces where a ruling was made and I filed an appeal for a review which was admitted by the Speaker. I moved the Motion, it was seconded, and a contributor from the Majority, Hon Dafeamekpor, had his bite on it and debate on it was suspended. Mr Speaker, it has been months since we raised this thing. They keep advertising it—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, with what you are drawing my attention to, once the Motion has been programmed in the *Order Paper*, what exactly do you want the Business Committee to do?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I am drawing attention to the fact that though it gets advertised, we never get to take it. The Leader of

Government Business drives public Business in this House, I am not the one who drives public Business. I am therefore bringing that to his attention, that each week, it is programmed, but we are unable to take it. Today is Friday; is it going to be business as usual? Because Mr Speaker, time is of the essence. We are talking about the livelihood of over 10,000 Ghanaian youth who have been sent home. They have lost their employment and livelihood. Mr Speaker, we, as the people's representatives, must be seen to be active. If a Motion is on this *Order Paper* for—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: My question still remains unanswered. What exactly do you want the Business Committee to do?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I want the Leader of Government Business who heads the Business Committee, to facilitate the taking of this Motion, so that the Rt Hon Speaker can make a determination on it. We must have finality.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What aspect of it do you want to be captured by the Business Statement that that has not been captured?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: The aspect that it always appears in the *Order Paper*, but nothing is done. Each week it is programmed and is part of Motions programmed for the ensuing week, but nothing happens. It has been so since June 13th. I keep raising this matter, because if I do not raise it, I will be told that I slept on my right and that I came to

equity as an indolent stakeholder. I want to come to equity with my eyes open, so, I do not want to be quiet. We raise it when we get to Conclave and on the Floor but nothing happens. So, I am doing so in good faith. If the Leader of Government Business is minded, we may take it today or if we would not be able to get it done today, then when we come next week Tuesday, we should be able to take it. Mr Speaker, on that score, I would want to rest my case.

Mr Speaker, if you would permit, my Deputy just brought the market fire at Kantamanto, Kumasi and Techiman and Kumasi—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I earlier ruled on that. So, once you are done—

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: On this market matter?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Very well. My Deputy Leader brought it up, so I felt I should—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I earlier ruled on that matter.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: I did not know. Mr Speaker, most respectfully, you said you had ruled on it and I said the Deputy Leader just came, so maybe she did not know. So that is fine.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Leader—Hon Sulemana, do you want to make comments on the Business Statement?

Alhaji Yusif Sulemana: Mr Speaker, I am very grateful. I want to commend the Business Committee for the elaborate Statement that they have presented to us this afternoon.

Before I raise this issue here, I want to make reference to a categorical statement that was made by Hon Annoh-Dompreh in which he said, that as a result of the fight against *galamsey*, excavators come and they vanish. This is a very serious statement he has made, and this is a House of records. If my respected Leader can give us evidence of where excavators—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Deputy Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, I always maintain that what we are doing during the time of Business Statement is not proper and is not within the rules. At the time of Business Statement, we do not debate. The Business Committee is supposed to have a meeting to outline programmes. Now, if the Business Statement is delivered, you can make comments and suggestions that will be taken on board. Those suggestions and comments should be limited to programmes that ought to have been on the Business Statement that did not appear on the Business Statement. But as usual, we reduce the time of the Business Statement to making statements that ought to have even been dealt with by Committees.

If what we are doing during Business Statement should be done during Business Statement, what are our Committees going to do? Some of the

issues being raised here for consideration by the Majority Leader are issues that ought to have been investigated, first of all, by the appropriate Committees. That is the reason for which we have Committees to deal with some of the issues and report to the House. The rules are clear as to what the Committees are supposed to do. If there is an issue to be handled by the Committee on Defence and Interior, please, let us give them the opportunity to do that. Now, during the time of Business Statement, you are coming to respond to a comment that another person has made.

2:18 p.m.

Should that be allowed during the period of the Business Statement? When issues are raised within the rules, the Leader and Chairman of the Business Committee would be called upon to address those issues.

No Member can get up to say that somebody has raised an issue; therefore, I want to respond to that particular issue. It does not happen when we are considering the Business Statement.

Let me also state that the Standing Orders are clear as to how you can raise a matter of urgent public importance. Make use of the rules. But during the time of the Business Statement, you cannot say you want to raise a matter of urgent public importance. You can do that for the time allotted for Statements. That is what the Standing Orders says. So, Hon Members, I urge all of us to

comply with the rules. Let us all operate within the rules. Other than that, every day, the Business Statement would be reduced to a debate.

I would therefore call on the Majority Leader to respond to issues that ought to have been responded to. Alhaji Yusif Sulemana, with all due respect, if it is a response to it, the Chairman of the Business Committee would respond.

All right, make that one statement and sit down.

Alhaji Yusif Sulemana: Mr Speaker, I want to thank you for this correction, and to say that what you have said is the right thing, and to also suggest that when it comes to time for Business Statement, we do not make statements that would provoke debate. Once Hon Member makes a statement that provokes debate, then, of course, the Hon Member would get a response. So, I respectfully agree with you, and that should be the standard. Do not make provocative and debatable issues, because if they do that, we would respond equally.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes. Chairman of the Business Committee.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think what the Hon Member for Bole Bamboi said is indeed the case. What you also said has become, unfortunately, a practice of this House. We have reduced

Business Statement time, and the comments that Hon Members may make into a time when we raise so many debatable issues.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh spoke about the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources. He knows the rules on how to get the Minister here. He has not asked an Urgent Question of the Minister nor has he brought a Motion to this House for consideration. He has done absolutely nothing in the past three weeks, apart from getting up every Friday and saying the Minister should be scheduled. Scheduled to come and do what? He has not asked the Minister a Question, so how can he be scheduled? We have not asked him a Question, and we have not told him there is an Urgent Question that he should come to this House and respond to.

So, getting up and saying the Minister should be scheduled to come and speak to *galamsey*, if he wants to come and speak to *galamsey*, he can come to speak to *galamsey*. But if he prefers to be in the field dealing with *galamsey*, I would recommend that he remain in the field dealing with *galamsey*. And if we invite him on an urgent matter, he would come.

When we invited him to come and answer some Questions the last time, even though he was in Brazil, he communicated and indicated the dates he would come. But when the Minority Chief Whip gets up every Friday and creates an impression that a Minister

does not want to come to this House and do his job, when he knows how to get the Minister to do his job in this House, and he has not told the world that he has done that, and yet the Minister has not responded, then he is being unfair to that Minister. He should ask an Urgent Question, and he would come and answer.

If the Minister feels a need to come and make a Statement on Government Policy. He would come and make a Statement on Government Policy. If he feels a need to come and report on any matter, he would come and report on any matter. But let us stop this drama of pretending that we are concerned about *galamsey*. *Galamsey* is happening in our various constituencies. What steps have we taken to deal with *galamsey* in his own constituencies? He is also a Leader there, the Member of Parliament there. Each and every one of us are Leaders and Members of Parliament, and we represent those constituencies. We sit there and see the *galamsey* happening. What have we done ourselves in our various constituencies before even asking the Minister who is sitting in Accra to come and answer for *galamsey* activities in our constituencies right under our noses?

He talked about the Accra-Kumasi Road, how many of them are MPs for the road from Accra to Kumasi? What have they done in their constituencies to deal with it? To think that it is the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources who must

come and deal with the problem. They are sitting there, the people who are digging are in their constituents, the police that are there are their police, the Assembly is their Assembly, and the Municipal and District Security Council is their Municipal and District Security Council. He is a member of the Assembly and the chiefs are their chiefs. Have they reported what they have tried to do in their constituencies as Members of Parliament to deal with *galamsey*? I have not received any report from any of them regarding what they have done in your constituency to fight *galamsey*. But they come and stand in this House and pretend they are concerned about *galamsey*. They say charity begins at home. They should show that they are concerned about *galamsey* by their actions in their constituencies.

Mr Speaker, the Ghana Health Service (GHS) has reported cases of monkeypox (Mpox), and I do agree that we should engage in public awareness creation *et cetera*. But it does not have to be the Minister. Indeed, the fact that we have become aware, it is because the Ghana Health Service is doing its work of notifying the public. But the main thing about Mpox is that it is transmitted through personal contact.

So, Minority Leader, avoid unnecessary personal contacts. If he avoids unnecessary personal contacts—
[Laughter]

Mr Annoh-Dompreh — rose —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minority Chief Whip, I have given him the opportunity to respond. So, if after the response, you have something to say, I can give you the floor. Please, if you draw my attention to it, I can ask it to be expunged from the record. So, I would give you the time.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Can I speak now? Majority Leader—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Allow the response. I would listen to you and do the needful within the rules.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: In this Parliament, are we saying that if one is on his feet and speaking, we cannot come under any of our Orders to bring your attention to a matter that has come up. No, it cannot be. Order 123; Content of Speech. Mr Speaker, the Majority Leader just said that we pretend to care about—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, why are we doing this to ourselves?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we are not doing anything; in this House, we are guided by your good self. The Leader we respect has used a word that is offensive. I have a right to rise up, and bring it to your attention.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is why I am saying that resume your seat. I

would give you the floor to make your point.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I would respect you and resume my seat.

Mr Ayariga: I said it, and I am going to repeat it, we should stop pretending that we are concerned about *galamsey*. We should demonstrate in our individual constituencies as Members of Parliament that indeed we are concerned about *galamsey*. I am saying it, and I am repeating it. Because so far, I have not received a single report from a Member of Parliament that they have taken any steps in their own constituencies to deal with the problem of *galamsey*.

2:28 p.m.

No one is mining in my Constituency. *[Interruption]* That is sand winning. There are no illegal mining operations that I know of in my constituency.

Mr Speaker, so like I said, on monkey pox, avoid unnecessary personal contacts and one will be able to deal with the problem.

For Zipline, even in my debate yesterday, I indicated clearly that I am against the Zipline contract. We cannot spend GHC170 million that we are sending blood to health facilities using drones. The Ministry of Health should have bought their own drones by now. We cannot continue spending that kind of money paying a service provider. It is a total waste of money. The Ministry of

Health should have bought their own drones, after all these years. The Zipline contract, I recall, was signed some time in 2021. Can we imagine every year if we are spending GHC170 million to drop blood in some village and then come back, meanwhile, there is road network leading to almost every town, every community in this country. There are only a few locations that we will say the roads are not accessible. That money could have tarred the roads to all those locations that we are concerned about and Ghana Health Service could have bought their own drones and done their own deliveries anytime they need to do a delivery. How much is a drone? Some drones are as cheap as US\$4,000 or US\$5,000. The most expensive drones do not even go beyond US\$10,000 or US\$20,000. By now, we would have had drones for every district in this country, managed by Ghana Health Service. Let us calculate the total amount of money we have wasted on this Zipline contract. I call for a cancellation of the contract. The contract should be canceled. Ghana Health Service should develop their own in-house capacity to deliver the blood through their own drones, and we would cut costs enormously. So please, that is my personal view of the matter.

Mr Speaker, I am very confident that the Ghana Armed Forces will extend their support for the organisation of the funerals of those who died in the stampede at the El-Wak Stadium. I believe that some arrangements will be made for the families. I do not have the details, but I believe it is something that they will do, because it is something that we always do as Ghanaians.

There was an issue about cocoa. I do agree with the Hon Minority Leader that the European Union (EU) has raised issues regarding traceability, and I know from the work that I do with Ghana Cocoa Board that they are indeed doing quite some work to ensure that we are able to trace where the cocoa beans are coming from to meet the EU requirements. So, Ghana Cocoa Board is working on it. I think that Cocoa Board is now under the Ministry of Finance and not Ministry of Food and Agriculture. So, if somebody has to come and answer to any Question regarding COCOBOD, it has to be the Minister for Finance. *[Interruption]* The Hon Member has not asked an Urgent Question so he should ask a Question. Mr Speaker just told him, the rules show an Hon Member what to do to get a Minister here compulsorily to answer a Question. At his level as a Leader, with an Urgent Question, the Ministers will come. But to say we should programme Ministers to come—Which provision of our Standing Orders says that I, as Leader, can programme Ministers to come and answer Questions? Show me the specific Standing Orders that say that I, as Leader of Government Business, should be programming Ministers.

If I ask a Minister to come, the Minister can ask, under what Orders am I asking him to come? So let us act according to our own Standing Orders. Ask Urgent Questions or Oral Questions; move Motions, and the Ministers will come. If Members move Motions in this House nobody hides a motion. **[Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** When we file them, you hide them] No, nobody hides your

Motions. Is the Hon Minority Leader now accusing the Speaker of hiding Motions? Because Motions do not come to me as Leader. **[Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** I am accusing those—*[Inaudible]*—The Clerk will not go to heaven. He hides our Motions and later say he could not find them] Motions go to the Speaker which he admits and programmed to be taken.

On markets, in the same way, ask Questions about the markets, and the Ministers will come and answer the Questions. Why do we have very few Questions scheduled for next week? It is because we already have a lot of Questions on the *Order Paper* which we are rolling over to next week. I think we have about 20 Questions already advertised. So, if we add the 20 to the 27, we already have close to—22 Questions have been advertised, so if we add the 22 to the 27, we are going to have 49 Questions for next week which I think should be adequate in terms of the programming of Questions.

Let me also indicate, as expressed by the Hon Member for Bole, that nobody has reported missing excavators. If there is a report of missing excavators, the Hon Member can ask the Minister and then he will come and answer. But nobody has reported any missing excavators.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompseh: Mr Speaker, I would urge the Hon Majority Leader to

exercise patience. He is the Leader of the House; he should exercise patience. He was not listening. So, he left two vital observations out. One, I have said that the Committee cluster system—I was suggesting to him, which will help the report of the estimate to be generated on time. He did not even comment on that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, if you make a suggestion to the Leader of Government Business and Chairman of the Business Committee, is it an offence that he did not comment on the suggestion that you have made?

Mr Annoh-Dompseh: Mr Speaker, I am not saying it is an offence. I am saying it is a vital—The Committee cluster. *[Interruption]* No, but he is the Leader of Government Business. Secondly, he also omitted a suggestion that we should sit at 2:00 p.m., so that the Committees will sit in the morning. It is a very important matter, but because he was angry and emotional, he lost out, that is fine.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, on that, you know clearly that it is not the House that is going to take that decision. I recall saying, and the *Hansard* will bear me out, that Leadership should engage. Instead of the Leadership engaging, at the time for Business Statement, you have not engaged and then come to a conclusion that this is what we are going to do. You are a Leader. Do you recall I directed that Leadership engage?

Mr Annoh-Dompseh: I am not in disagreement. Now let me go to a

substantive matter. I am not impressed how the Hon Majority Leader has tackled this matter. We are talking about *galamsey*, and the Hon Majority Leader is saying that when the Minister feels like coming to the House, and we should—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, I rule that during the time for Business Statement, we should not reduce it to a debate. That was the more reason for which when the Deputy Minister for Lands and Natural Resources wanted to respond to you, I quickly stop him. So why are you going into that area again?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, let me explain myself properly, and quote what you said yourself. Thankfully, you were presiding last week, and when I raised the matter, the Hon Majority Leader said that the Minister will be in the House as many times as possible.

2:38 p.m.

And Mr Speaker, you said yes; you corroborated with the Leader's statement. Then I came back to ask the position we are adopting, whether the Minister is coming or not. Now he says that I should go and file a Question when he knows we have difficulty; we are about to consider the Budget Estimates. He is the same person who came and told me that the Minister is meeting the committee for the Budget Estimate. He is simply shielding the Minister.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, the Minister is asking—

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: No, I am putting it to the Majority Leader that he is shielding the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Under the rules, point to the Leader which rules he would use to ask the Minister to come to the House. That is why I indicated that there are tools available for us.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I will not do this with you. You are my good Friend.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, if you ask an Urgent Question, no matter the circumstances, the Minister must come here and answer.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, but the Business Statement is presented to this House for adoption. Our Standing Orders state that it is the Business Committee that makes proposals to the Plenary, then the Plenary can make input into the Business Statement.

I had earlier given a heads-up that this matter is important, and even at the Business Committee, I raised the matter again. So, Mr Speaker, what more can I do?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Today, at the Plenary, the Chairman of the Committee says that if you need a

Minister urgently to come and respond to a Question, use the rules.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, with the greatest respect, I have not gone beyond the rules; I am well within the rules, that is why we are doing this engagement. Mr Speaker, you are very experienced. You know the importance of the Business Statement and why we need to make input. But, fair, I am not going to—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, let us just analyse the statement that you have made that when you ask a Question, we will say we are in a period where it will be difficult to consider Questions for a Minister to come and respond to. Do you think that, given the same exigency, it will be all right for the Business Committee to programme the Minister to come here?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, with respect, I believe the matter of *galamsey*, which concerns our water bodies, lands and very livelihood, is urgent. But I am well guided. But when the Leader says that “when the Minister feels...” He used the words, “when he feels like.” We are the representatives of the people. Do we not have an oversight role? But it is all right. Now I get it clear.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: If you look at Standing Order 91, the rules say that the Minister, on his own volition, can come and make Statements. Let me just read the Order.

“Statement by the Speaker and Minister

91. (1) The Speaker may make a statement on any matter of interest to the House.

(2) A Minister of State may make a statement of government policy, and the statement shall

(a) be limited to facts which are necessary to be made known to the House; and

(b) not contain matters that are likely to provoke debate.”

So, it means that the Minister, on his own volition, can come to this House and make a Statement. The Minister can also be compelled. So, the use of the word “willingly” is within the rules.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, it is all right. We should draw the curtains on this matter. I am guided, but the conclusion is not for me to draw; the conclusion is for the people of this country to draw. The Leader is saying that when the Minister feels like coming to Parliament, he will come. We are all watching. The people of this country are watching. I will leave my case here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The general public is aware that any time the Business Statement is presented, then we say we are going to do Friday politics. Friday politics is not known to our rules.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, for heaven's sake, I am not doing any Friday politics. For the record, I am not aware of any Friday politics.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I am on the floor.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I have not given you the floor. You just stood up and put on the microphone.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, you just said that we are doing Friday politics. Nobody is doing Friday politics.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I did not mention your name.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: No, but Mr Speaker, you made that open statement about Friday politics. I am representing the people of Nsawam/Adoagyiri. I am not doing Friday politics.

Mr Ayariga: He is doing Friday politics. I am saying that he is doing Friday politics because he knows the rules very clearly. The rules show him how he can get Ministers to this House. He can ask Questions; urgent or oral Questions, and Ministers come and respond to the Questions.

For five weeks now, he has been talking about *galamsey*, but he has not asked a single Question about *galamsey*.

And that is why I keep saying that he should not pretend like he is interested in *galamsey* matters. Then on Fridays, he would use the airtime and media to discuss *galamsey* as if he were concerned about it. The rules are clear on how one can manifest a concern. The mechanism for manifesting a concern is asking specific Questions to the Minister. He has not asked the Minister any specific Question and yet, he gets up on his feet to run down a Minister.

That is what he has done today. He ran down a Minister, indicating that if the Minister comes, he should show the turbidity level of River Pra. Is it the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources who should be telling us the turbidity levels of water? It is the Minister for Works Housing, and Water Resources. It is not the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources. The person who tests the turbidity levels of water is the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources, who oversees the Ghana Water Company. Just to let him know.

He could ask a simple question that the Minister should come and tell us the turbidity levels of River Ayensu, River Pra or whichever river he wants. He would not ask that simple question, then he comes here to talk and create the impression that he is concerned about something. But when it comes to the mechanism for manifesting the concern, which is available to him, he does not use it. Why would I not say that he is just

pretending? That is why I said that we should not pretend that we are concerned about *galamsey*.

If he is really concerned about *galamsey*, he should ask specific Questions about *galamsey*. The Minister will come and answer because he is obliged to do so. He should not say that I should schedule him to come and brief us on *galamsey*. He should leave the work that he is doing, fighting *galamsey* in the forest, and come and brief us every day. How can that happen?

Mr Speaker, the issue of clusters that he mentioned is not a matter within my domain. These are reforms of how the Parliamentary Service is organised which is initiated by the Clerk's Office. I think that the cluster system should not delay a Committee's Report. The cluster system simply is that we can bring five Committees together and put them under one senior clerk, but each of the Committees will maintain its own Committee clerk. I think that is how the cluster system works. So, the Committees have their clerks, and all of them answer to one supervisor. So, the fact that somebody has been appointed a supervisor of a set of clerks so that he oversees those clerks does not justify delays in presenting the Reports of those Committees.

So, the Reports may just be a result of the Committee clerks not doing their work. So let us urge the Committee clerks to do their work and not blame the

cluster system. But if the heads of clusters are insisting on reviewing their reports before signing them off, and yet they are not making the time to review their reports, that will cause a delay in the reports being signed off. So, I urge the Clerk to Parliament to ensure that no cluster head holds Committee Reports unreasonably. We have attached the schedule for the consideration of Committee Reports, and we are going to go according to those Reports strictly. And if any Committee's Report is delayed or not made available, and we decide that we want to take action, we demand that the Clerk to Parliament takes disciplinary action against the clerk of that Committee.

2:48 p.m.

Lastly, also, on our new arrangement to have public hearings of the sector estimates, let me dispel the fears that I hear being expressed. I think it is to take some input from interest groups. So far, when the Ministry of Finance is preparing the Budget, they have what they call the pre-Budget hearings. We as Parliament are not privy to the pre-Budget hearings. Ministers who are Members of Parliament may be privy to the pre-Budget hearings. But we as Members of Parliament are not and our Committee Chairpersons are not.

When the Budgets come to us, it is already formed by the Ministry of Finance based on negotiations that have been held with the various sector

Ministers. We as a Parliament, want to take feedback from civil society and interest groups regarding what their take is, on the proposals for the different sectors. It does not mean that the sectoral allocations will change. But the views of civil society and interest groups should be taken on board when we as Members of Parliament are analysing the estimates and the policy proposals from the various sectors. So that, the public would feel that they participated in the work that we are doing.

When we have our reports, they would capture some sentiments and pieces of advice that are coming from interest groups and stakeholders. Our debate and conclusions would also make recommendations to the Minister for Finance or even the sector Ministers that in future they take on board these concerns coming from civil society, stakeholders and interest groups when they are developing the next set of policies that they would bring to this House for approval. It only enhances governance, brings it closer to the people and it enables people to get involved in governance of the country.

Indeed, year after year, when you take the Afrobarometer reports, when it comes to Parliament, one of the longstanding complaints is that we do not engage with the citizenry. These are platforms for engaging with the citizenry. Yes, we sit here, rise on our feet and debate. It is live on television; they watch and see what we do.

But then, how do they make input? We either go to our constituencies, solicit

their views, come back here and then make inputs during debate, taking on board those views or as Committee, we invite them as witnesses before the Committee and solicit their views on the matters that we are about to deliberate on. Then, take on board their views when we are deliberating and when we report, we should let them see that as they sit and watch us, their views have reflected in the reports of the Committees and in the debates, we have addressed their concerns.

That is how citizens would feel that they are being consulted and are being involved in governance. They should not wait until election time before they make their opinion known as to whether you are governing well or not. What we are doing now, is the reason we get shocked during elections. Because you would see a large number for National Democratic Congress (NDC) then an election comes, and there is a massive swing in favour of the New Patriotic Party (NPP). The same way would see a large support base for NPP, then election comes, then suddenly, there is a huge support going to the NDC.

This is because during the period of governance, they were not listening to them. So, you are not taking on board their concerns so the only time that they have to express their concern is at the ballot box. But if every day they take on board their concerns, involved them and they are satisfied, we would see that governance would be enhanced. If one passes a tax, they would pay. If they are not to go there, they would stay away from that and if you say they must

comply with this regulation, they would comply. Because they participated, engaged with us and there is consensus between us and the citizenry as to exactly how this country should be governed.

I urge Chairpersons and Ranking Members of the Committees, the Clerk to Parliament and the clerks of the various Committees to use this facility. We have invested in the facility and Committee proceedings can be aired live. So as deliberations in this Chamber, no matter how rancorous, is aired live, I do not see why we should be concerned or be afraid of showing Committee proceedings live. Because nothing is secret.

The Budget document is already a public document. The figures there are of public knowledge. Anybody who wants to analyse it, can do so. So, to say that they should come and comment on the figures and it should be on television, I do not see why anybody should be scared or concerned about this. If we are not concerned about what is coming out at the Public Accounts Committee, I cannot imagine why we would be concerned about what will come out when the Committee on Education meets to consider the allocation to the Ghana Education Service (GES).

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, out of patriotism, I had tried to assist the Majority Frontbench. Last year, towards the passage of the

Appropriation Bill, we experienced things that the Majority Leader does not know of. But that is fine. If it is the case that he wants to stand by the position that the cluster system must stay, then it should stay. Now, it is just a pro bono counsel.

My last one had to do with the formerly, the District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF)—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, I do not like a situation where a wrong impression would be created. The cluster system is not put in place by the Business Committee. So how is the Business Committee going to deal with the cluster system?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, for heaven's sake, let us get practical here. The Business Committee works closely with the Table Office and they also closely with the Clerk to Parliament. This system was put together by the Clerk and they work closely working with the Business Committee. The two are inseparable. I am not going to comment further on this matter. I would just leave it as it is. Let us work with the cluster system.

I was going to speak to the appendix attached, that is the Motions that we are scheduled to take. I see we have the— We want to help to get things done. If they want to rubbish us and say that it is not important, that is fine. We can all sit down—*[Interruption]*

Yes, but the reactions coming in sometimes makes us feel we are not supportive. We want to support them to

get the Appropriation Bill passed. The first Motion we are scheduling is with the National Media Commission. I know it is based on availability of the Estimates.

Oftentimes, we tend to rush to get things done at the last minute in relation to the DACF, National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) and the Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund). My checks reveal that they are ready. So, I am humbly suggesting that we could programme them for next week, either Thursday or Friday, for either of them. Because I know the formulae for DACF is ready, then we can take it at the Committee of the Whole. There are a lot of issues that concern Colleagues so we can deal with them.

Mr Speaker, these are my views. I thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Business Statement as presented is hereby adopted.

Yes, Majority Leader?

An Hon Member — *rose* —

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Why is the Hon Member revealing his height? It is a short one. Zacchaeus is taller than you—
[*Interruption*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, I did not see you on your feet—

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think we agreed that after the Business Statement, we will take an adjournment Motion. Because of the funeral we

attended, Members had to come very early.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leader?

2:58 p.m.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I notified my respected Colleague on this matter. It has to do with us as Members of Parliament. The Speaker, yesterday, made a ruling on the matter and brought clarity but the problem is that just this afternoon, Hon Matthew Nyindam came to me in my office and expressed a grave concern. His concern has to do with the judgement of the Tamale High Court, where the judge said on Friday, he would get the judgement after making a ruling against him on Monday.

Mr Speaker, as at 2:00 p.m. that I walked with him from my office to this Chamber, his lawyer was still at the court and I am quoting the lawyer, “that the registrar says the judgement is not ready and my lord is in Accra”.

Mr Speaker, in view of how this matter affects his rights as a Member of Parliament, I am only bringing it up into the public space one more time and before you, because my Hon Brother, Mr Dafeamekpor raised it for our deliberation and Mr Speaker pronounced on it. My understanding was to the effect that the judgement would be ready for him to explore the necessary appellate processes.

Mr Speaker, if a court of justice with a judge sitting as a judge of equity and of law, makes a determination of a matter that has far-reaching consequences, knowing that indeed, this pronouncement has an effect, and how the Member who is affected can exercise rights, the means to exercise rights is not available. As we speak, the registry of the court has closed; the registrar says the judgement is not ready, the judge is going to Accra and he left Tamale at 10 a.m.

Mr Speaker, these have constitutional implications, and I feel that as the Leader of my Caucus and an Hon Member of my Caucus, having come to me with such grave concerns, especially so when the ruling, if we are counting the statutory seven days' automatic stay, what it means is that the seven days starts from the Monday. Meanwhile, the judgement upon which the order emanates is not even ready.

Mr Speaker, the rule is that one cannot place something on nothing; it will fall. A ruling or an order is extracted from a judgement. You and I have been in the courtroom for many years. A judgement is read, and in that judgement, even before the order is executed, there is an extract out of the judgement, and it is that extract that we call in legal terms, "a court order". Now, how can the court order be ready, telling the whole world that he is no more an MP or directing an organ of state to go and conduct elections, but the substance, that parties

can look at and say, let me exercise my right, is not ready? The judge in open court tells the whole world that it will be ready on Friday. Parties go there, the affected Member of Parliament is in the court, he sits there, they say the judge has come to Accra and up to this time, no judgement is ready.

Mr Speaker, I believe that our Judiciary should help us the more, and help the situation, and bring certainty and clarity, so that—Hon Colleagues, it can be us tomorrow. I am not, no—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, temporarily resume your seat.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, very well.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minority Leader, with all due respect to everybody, I believe the ruling of the Speaker should bring a closure to this issue. Hon Members, matters within the ambit of the Judiciary must be dealt with by the Judiciary. You rightly stated the other time, that Parliament cannot be constituted into a court to give an interpretation. Hon Minority Leader, whether a judge failed to deliver a judgement, whether the judgement is available or is not available, what has that exactly got to do with the lawmaker, which is the Legislature?

Hon Minority Leader, let us stand by the ruling delivered by the Speaker, and bring closure to this particular issue.

When a procedure is set down for a right to be exercised, I think the authorities are clear and it is trite learning that it is that procedure alone that will have to be followed in exercising your rights. So, please, with all due respect, let us bring a closure. So, on this note —

Mr Dafeamekpor — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: If it is a comment on what he is saying and I am stopping him, then I would plead with you that I do not want our *Hansard*— Hon Dafeamekpor, in the name of the Almighty God, I am pleading with you that we bring a closure to this. We cannot use Parliamentary forum to be doing what we are doing. It is not the best. More so, we are all members of the legal fraternity. So, please.

Mr Dafeamekpor: What the Minority Leader is doing to the judge is not fair. They filed a Notice of Appeal at 10:04 a.m. Judgement was delivered 9:56 a.m. By 10:04 a.m., they filed a Notice of Appeal with three grounds. What they are waiting for is the reasoned full judgement. But they have already filed their Notice of Appeal and followed it up with an Application of Notice for Stay of Execution — Please, Hon Minority Leader, I listened to him carefully. So, keep quiet while I respond. He has filed an Application of Notice and have decided to run the judge down and it is not proper.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, for now, I will urge the two of you to resume your seats.

[Mr First Deputy Speaker rises to be heard in silence pursuant to Standing Order 126(2)]

Hon Members, as indicated, this is not and cannot be the appropriate forum to do what we are about to do. So, on this note, the chapter on that particular issue is perpetually closed. You can go and address the matter with the Judiciary, but not in Parliament.

Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: I think we agree that we will take an adjournment.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Then, let the Motion be moved.

Before the Motion is moved, let me acknowledge the presence of students from Harion International school, led by Mr Emmanuel Apoh Ofori, a teacher, and they are from Mfantseman. They are 136 in number.

My revered students, you are welcome to Parliament of Ghana. May you have a fruitful stay.

[Students of Harion International school were acknowledged.]

3:08 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, I beg to move that this House adjourns until Tuesday at noon.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, any seconder?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, I have no hesitation at all in seconding the Motion ably moved by the Leader of Government Business. However, I pray that we consider just one item, the Motion numbered 29, on page 11 of today's *Order Paper*.

Mr Speaker, the reason this Motion has to be considered as quickly as possible is that it has to do with the growing unemployment situation in our country.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, are you moving a counter Motion?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, no. I am saying that this Motion has to deal with the many youths who have been dismissed through the letter of the Chief of Staff, and I support the adjournment. This Motion has long been appearing in the *Order Paper*, and many of our youths who are breadwinners—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, are you seconding the Motion?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, may hear me. What I am saying

is that the Hon Leader wants us to adjourn —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, there is a Motion on the Floor that we are dealing with.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I am opposed to the Motion, and I am stating my grounds for opposition.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, it is for good reasons that Mr Dafeamekpor and I read law, and Mr Speaker himself is also a lawyer.

Mr Speaker, I am opposed to this Motion.

When Mr Speaker was practising, we were in school, and he knows how much I respect him. Not many have spent their time in the courtroom; it is just a few of us.

Mr Speaker, I am opposed to the application by the respected Leader of Government Business. My opposition to his Motion is grounded on one matter, which is the matter contained on page 11, the item numbered 29, Private Member's Motion. This Motion has been advertised for today, and we have not exhausted the *Order Paper* for today. The *Order Paper* contains various items, including the Motion numbered 29, which reads, and I quote:

“That pursuant to Order 127 of the Standing Orders, the Rt Hon

Speaker reviews the ruling of the First Deputy Speaker on 5th March, 2025 sustaining the preliminary objection raised by Hon Majority Leader, Mr Mahama Ayariga, against moving the Private Members' Motion listed as item number 16 on page 6 of the Order Paper for Wednesday, 5th March, 2025 and same captured in the Official Report of the House for the said date."

Mr Speaker, the Motion has to do with the directive of the Chief of Staff ordering various state institutions to terminate the appointment of many who were employees of state institutions —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, you would agree with me that mostly, we do not exhaust all items on the *Order Paper* before we take adjournment. You can prove me wrong—

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, you are right —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Again—
Let me finish.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Very well.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Again, when Hon Leaders come to the Business Committee and agree on Businesses that are supposed to be taken and at what point we should adjourn, and the reasons are canvassed, I do not expect any of the Hon Leaders to act to the contrary.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, do not belabour. If it is the case that there was some prior arrangement, I was attending to some other duties, and

in fact, I did not discuss what happened at Conclave with my Colleague. I would concede if indeed, the understanding was that this Motion, which has to do with the dismissal of Ghanaian youth from the employ of state institutions, will not be taken today. I withdraw my initial request to plead with the Hon Majority Leader because I thought this is a national matter, and that many people who have been sent home are suffering, so we should do it at a later date —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, you are completely out of order.

Minority Leader (Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin): Mr Speaker, that is why I am withdrawing, so that I can second the Motion for the adjournment. I, therefore, second the Motion for adjournment, if that is the concern.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Hon Minority Leader boasted about his many years of courtroom practice. I am surprised because Order 105 deals with Motions, and anyone with significant courtroom practice will see that when a Motion is moved, it has to be seconded. If one is not seconding it, one cannot be moving their own Motion. What he did was move his own Motion when the Motion that had been moved had not been seconded. If he knew he was not going to second it, he should have allowed someone else to second it, then he could have risen to oppose. That is proper courtroom practice. So, he should not be doing these things.

Mr Speaker, it is his Chief Whip who came to us at Conclave and suggested that after the Business Statement, we adjourn. The Speaker was there, and I agreed with him that after the Business Statement, we will adjourn because of the funeral. So, for him to get up and try to embarrass me that I have moved the Motion for adjournment, and that he is against the Motion for adjournment —

Mr Speaker, I am ready to do Business. Hon Ministers came here wanting to Answer their Questions, but we said no, we would not take the Question because we have agreed that we are going to adjourn, so that Hon Members who came very early to attend the funeral—Since the funeral started very early—

Mr Speaker, let us stop doing these things. I think the Motion has been seconded by him, so you may give your —[**An Hon Member:** He did not second it.] No, he seconded it.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, the Hon Majority Leader just drew my attention to best practices.

Mr Speaker, I have always been arguing against this rule of convenience of his. I have him on record where he moved a Motion to vary the Selection Committee Report in this House without it being seconded. Where were the rules? An Hon Member raised it that the Motion has not been seconded, and this Side carried it. When it was asked, they said, Parliament is master of its own rules. So, when he moved a Motion to vary a report of a Committee to remove somebody from a delegation, and it was not

seconded, was it a proper Motion? Please, let us not go there. The situation where some people take it that they are in control of this House, therefore, they do something, and then they say it is right. Then, when matters are being raised, they turn around and say it has to be seconded, and want to school a person on the rule book; I read the rules all the time. I would show him the *Hansard*.

Mr Speaker, he is laughing; why does he not debate me on this?

3:18 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, when we come here to speak, we speak to the whole world. The practice is that, when a Motion is moved, that Motion is supposed to be seconded. After the Motion is seconded, it is for the consideration of the House. So, during the period that the Motion is being considered, there can be opposition or a counter Motion. Hon Member, preliminary objection is also different from—

Hon Members, the Motion is moved and seconded for adjournment, it is for the consideration of the House.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 3:18 p.m. till Tuesday, 2nd December, 2025, at 12 noon.

Editor's Note

This Official Report was corrected by the House on 10th December, 2025.

